

Asrar Maqbool

asrarwani102@gmail.com | [+46-76 457 38 25](tel:+46764573825) | [LinkedIn](#) | Fogdevreten 15, Solna, 17 165

Education:

Karolinska Institutet (Expected: Jun '27)

Master's Programme in Bioentrepreneurship

Institute of Chemical Technology, Mumbai (Jun '24)

B. Tech in Pharmaceuticals Chemistry and Technology

Work Experience:

CytaCoat, Stockholm, Sweden

New Market & Product Strategy Intern

April '26 - present

- Conducting a strategic market and product analysis for CytaCoat AB that has developed a novel anti-fouling and anti-biofilm coating designed to reduce healthcare-associated infections (HAIs) linked to medical devices.
- Identifying and evaluating new business segments and product opportunities where CytaCoat's advanced antimicrobial coating can create value.
- Deliverables include a structured evaluation framework, ranked product recommendations, and a business case covering market entry strategy, competitive landscape analysis, partnership potential, regulatory feasibility, and risk assessment.

Willuhn Consulting, Stockholm, Sweden

Associate to Managing Director

Nov '25 - present

- I support strategic initiatives across digital, market, and consulting functions. I lead development of a new company website, contributed to market expansion through research and analysis, and conducting CMC consulting research to support client engagements and business development.

Amar Biosystems Pvt. Ltd., Mumbai, India (*A sister company of Amar Equipment*)

Business Development Assistant

Jun '24 - Jun '25

- Initiated and led business development initiatives for the startup specializing in microfluidics and microreactor-based technologies for the life sciences industry, focusing on marketing healthcare solutions for mRNA lipid nanoparticles, polymeric nanoparticles, and Cell and Gene Therapy (CGT) while identifying and establishing collaborations with companies and institutions to validate our equipment.
- Accelerated business development by market research and engaging prospects across target sectors and securing qualified leads through product promotion at premier industry exhibitions.
- Amplified global brand visibility and dealer network performance by architecting digital marketing campaigns that boosted user engagement by 89% and increased leads by 65% via SEO implementation.

Leadership Experience:

iGEM Stockholm

Jan '26 - present

Wiki Project Lead and Finance Team Member

- Leading a 6-person wiki team building the official competition website for iGEM Stockholm 2026, whose project develops a synthetic biology platform for degrading Bisphenol A (BPA), a widespread endocrine-disrupting pollutant.
- Architected the wiki's technical foundation from scratch using React, Vite, and Tailwind CSS with React Router, replacing the standard iGEM Flask boilerplate with a modern component-based stack designed for faster iteration and a stronger visual identity at competition.
- Managing the full development pipeline local environment, Netlify staging deployment for team preview, and the migration path to iGEM's GitLab CI/CD for the live competition.
- Coordinating content contributions across sub-teams (wet lab, dry lab, human practices, entrepreneurship) into a single coherent narrative for a global scientific and judging audience, ensuring compliance with iGEM's technical requirements.
- Contributing to financial planning, budgeting, and grant strategy; secured early-stage funding through successful competitive grant applications to KTH Royal Institute of Technology (150,000 SEK) and Karolinska Institutet (25,000 SEK) to support laboratory work, team travel, and competition participation.

Business Committee (Näringslivsutskottet), Medicinska Föreningen, KI.

Nov '25 – present

Corporate Relations Manager

- Leading corporate outreach and partnership-building for CHaSE (Careers in Health and Science Exposition), KI's annual life-science career fair held at Aula Medica, connecting 800+ students, PhDs, and postdocs with leading employers in pharma, biotech, medtech, and health sciences.
- Serve as External Relations Manager for NU Pulse, the committee's podcast launched in collaboration with Bayer as headline sponsor; lead guest acquisition and industry partnerships, manage pre-interview research and editorial preparation, and secured guests spanning academic faculty and industry leaders to give students an inside look at careers across academia and industry.
- Direct the committee's marketing and brand strategy across digital channels, building a cohesive identity for both CHaSE and NU Pulse and growing engagement with the KI student community.
- Develop tailored partnership pitches and proposals, repositioning CHaSE engagement as a talent pipeline and ecosystem-building opportunity and manage end-to-end partnership lifecycle from prospecting through contracting.

Manager at Tinkerers' Lab, ICT Mumbai

Jun '23 – May '24

- As the inaugural Facility Manager, played a key role in establishing the lab from the ground up. Managed a team of 10 responsible for daily operations and provided mentorship to students on their projects.
- Tinkerers' Lab is a valuable ecosystem that fosters experimentation and problem-solving by allowing budding engineers to tinker with systems and develop prototypes.

Marketing & Hospitality Head at UPL Vortex 10.0, ICT Mumbai

Sep '22 – Jun '23

- Led a 50+ student team to deliver Asia's largest student-run ChemFest, supported by Royal Society of Chemistry and UNESCO, drawing 5,000+ participants on a budget of INR 2.2 million (~€26,000), with industry backing from UPL, Dow, Aditya Birla, Alkyl Amines, and Aarti Industries.

Internships:

Indian Institute of Technology, Bombay

May '23 – Aug '23

Guide: **Prof. Abhijit Majumder**, *M-Lab, Department of Chemical Engineering, IIT Bombay*

- Contributed to an extensive research project, driving the investigation of the mechanosensitive properties of NEAT1, a prominent long non-coding RNA (lncRNA). Our research provided conclusive evidence of NEAT1's significant downregulation in glioblastoma cancer cells.
- Our research unveiled that the suppression of NEAT1 had a distinct and measurable effect on a range of cancer markers, indicating a compelling prospect for the identification of a promising therapeutic target.

Final year Project - Institute of Chemical Technology, Mumbai

Aug 2023 – Jun '24

Guide: **Dr. Prajakta Dandekar Jain**, *Asst. Prof., Pharmaceutical Sciences and Technology, ICT, Mumbai*

Topic: Systematic approach to optimization and validation of bioprinting parameters for in-house bio-inks

- Undertook a comprehensive project involving literature review and systematic pre-printing, printing, and post-printing experiments to optimize and validate in-house composite bioinks, while implementing a meticulous methodology to refine key quantifiable parameters critical for successful bioprinting outcomes.

Technical Innovations:

- **Aurgoform** - Automated Organ-on-Chip Instrument:

Collaborated with a cross-disciplinary research team at the Institute of Chemical Technology, Mumbai on the development and launch of Aurgoform, India's first automated organ-on-chip prototype showcased at the International Conference on Advances in 3D Cell Culture 2024. Worked alongside PhD and postdoctoral researchers to coordinate prototype design, integrate automation components, and streamline testing workflows. Contributed to project planning, resource management, and milestone tracking, ensuring timely delivery of a functional system that revolutionizes in-vitro modeling for drug screening and personalized medicine applications.

Hobbies and Interests:

Cycling, Trekking, Music, Films, Cooking

Languages:

English (fluent), Swedish (Intermediate), Kashmiri (fluent), Urdu (fluent), Hindi (fluent)